



Fig. 2: (L) A paper disk with a white patch, fitted onto a DC motor spindle, and (R) stationary patches of red and green colours seen when the frequency of the stroboscope equals that of rotation of the disk

and pressing S2 slightly reduces the frequency. The change in frequency will make the patches to move in either clockwise or anti-clockwise direction.

Switch S3 provides a direct way to toggle between continuous and pulsed

variable time periods. When switch S3 is thrown to continuous mode, the lights (LED1 through LED4) never go off—green and red LEDs glow alternately. For 50 per cent duty cycle of NE555, both red and green light go on

and off alternately for the same duration. Use bright red and green LEDs for a good stroboscope output.

To measure the revolutions per minute (RPM) of the disk, tune the frequency using VR1 until stationary red and green patches are seen on the rotating disk. Next, note the reading of the ammeter to get revolutions per second (RPS) of the disk or motor. Multiply the result by 60 to get the RPM.

The stroboscope can be used to measure the RPM of a ceiling fan or table fan. For good visibility, make sure that the fan is clean and the light in the room switched off. Focus the red and green LED lights on the wings of the rotating fan. Vary VR1 until stationary red and green lights are seen on the wings of the rotating fan. Read the ammeter and divide the reading by 3 (for three wings of the fan) to get the rotation speed in RPS. ●

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I, Ramesh Chopra, hereby declare that the particulars given above are true to the best of my knowledge and belief.

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